

More than 6,000 rebels were crucified following Spartacus's revolt



73 BCE

SLAVE REVOLT AGAINST ROME

In a revolt that began in Capua, Thracian gladiator Spartacus led a band of fighters including his fellow gladiators and escaped slaves. They vanquished several Roman armies, plundered a number of cities, and almost reached Rome itself. In 71 BCE, an army led by Licinius Crassus defeated the rebels in Calabria. Thousands of them were crucified along the Appian Way.

◀ Gladiator combat, Roman mosaic



106–48 BCE

POMPEY THE GREAT

One of Rome's greatest generals and a member of the First Triumvirate ruling Rome from 59 BCE, Pompey fell out with his fellow triumvir Julius Caesar, lost the ensuing civil war, and was assassinated.

65 BCE **Pompey**
defeats Mithridates
of Pontus to end the
Mithridatic Wars

61 BCE

63 BCE

ROMANS ANNEX JUDAEA

The commander of the Roman army in the East, Pompey the Great, had deposed the last Seleucid ruler of Syria in 64 BCE, making his kingdom into a Roman province. He then turned his attention to Judaea, which was riven by a civil war between the rival rulers Hyrcanus and Aristobulus. Hyrcanus opened the gates of Jerusalem to Pompey's forces, which then besieged the Temple Mount for three months before storming it and massacring thousands. Pompey annexed part of Judaea and left the rest under client rulers, including Hyrcanus.

▷ Desecration of the Temple of Jerusalem

